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Regional Flora

It includes large geographical area or a botanical region. Example: 'Flora of Tamil Nadu' Carnatic by **K.M.Matthew** (1983), 'Flora of Madras Presidency' by **J.S. Gamble** and **Fischer**.

Continental Flora

This flora covers the entire continent. Example: 'Flora of Europaea' by D.A.Web.

Electronic Floras (e - floras)

It is nothing but the digitized form of a flora published online. Example: 'e – Flora China'. This provides the information and also functions as an identification tool.

3. Monograph

A Monograph is a complete global account of a taxon of any rank – family, genus or species at a given time. This includes the existing taxonomic knowledge and all relevant information about the group concerned such as Anatomy, Biochemistry, Palynology, Chromosome Number and Phylogeny. It also includes extensive literature review, all nomenclatural information, identification key to all taxa, citation of specimens examined and distribution map.

Example: The Family *Lentibulariaceae* by Peter Tylor.

Revisions

Taxonomic revision is carried out for a family or genus. Usually taxonomic revision is less comprehensive than a monograph for a given geographical area. Revisions normally incorporate keys to identify the taxa, short descriptions, often confined to diagnostic characters, distribution maps and a classification. Illustrations mostly in the form of line drawings are included both in monographs and revisions. There are difficulties in identifying various members within a taxon. If there is inconsistency of the characters within the taxon's geographic range then a revision is needed. Taxonomic revisions are primarily based on original research work. Example: Malvaceae of India by T.K.Paul, Venu. P. 2006 Strobilanthes (Acanthaceae) in Peninsular India.

Catalogues

Catalogues are the books of libraries rich in botanical titles. They have special value in taxonomic studies. To refer a catalogue, one should know full name of the author, exact title of the book, exact date of publication the particulars of edition.

Example: Catalogue of the Library of British Museum (of Natural History) Catalogue of the Library of the Massachusetts Horticultural Society.

5.7 Botanical Gardens

In true sense all gardens are not botanical gardens. Botanical gardens are centres for collection of plants in their various stages of living. Gardens existed for growing ornamental plants for aesthetic value, religious and status reasons. The famous "hanging gardens" of Babylon in Mesopotamia is an example. For the purpose of science and education the first garden was maintained by **Theophrastus** in his public lecture hall at Athens.

First modern botanical garden was established by **Luca Ghini** (1490-1556) a professor of Botany at Pisa, Italy in 1544.